

Meriç Erler

Game Economy Designer - F2P & Idle Systems

Berlin, Germany | mericerler@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/mericerler | github.com/merogith
EU work-authorized | English (full professional), Turkish (native) | Available immediately

Summary

Game Economy Designer focused on free-to-play (F2P) and idle games, with three years of data analysis across pharma, edtech and equity research. I balance game economies by the numbers: sources and sinks, inflation control, progression curves, retention, and monetization. To demonstrate the skill set directly, I built a full, self-directed economy-design study on Idle Bank Tycoon - a parameter-driven model in Excel and Google Sheets (400+ linked formulas) with two live-ops levers, ROI and monetization math, sensitivity analysis, and an A/B test plan, modelling a blended ARPDAU lift of +15.5%. I also build and ship my own browser games, so I read an economy from both the spreadsheet and the code.

Core Skills

- **Game economy & F2P:** economy modelling and balancing; sources/sinks and inflation control; progression curves; monetization (IAP, rewarded ads, ARPDAU, ARPPU, eCPM); retention (D1/D7/D30); player psychology, motivation and segmentation.
- **Spreadsheet modelling:** advanced Excel and Google Sheets - parameter-driven models, 400+ linked formulas, sensitivity grids, scenario and A/B design.
- **Data analysis & methods:** Python (pandas, scikit-learn, statsmodels); SQL (window functions); A/B testing; regression; z-tests; logistic models; forecasting.
- **BI & reporting:** Tableau, Power BI, Looker Studio, Google Analytics, KPI dashboards.
- **Build / technical:** custom game engines in JavaScript / TypeScript (Canvas, game loop, rules-vs-render separation); concepts that carry over to Unity; Supabase; Git.

Selected Projects

- **Idle Bank Tycoon - Game Economy Design Case Study** (Excel/Google Sheets model, A/B design). Found the late-game problem in the numbers: by level 60, idle cash accumulates to 4,900-21,600x the next upgrade's cost, so progression stops mattering. Designed two live-ops levers, a hard-currency liquidity lock and income-scaled rewarded-ad tuning, and modelled each to a blended ARPDAU +15.5% (about \$2M/year at static DAU), with a sensitivity grid and retention guardrails. My recommendation: ship the ad tuning first and treat the loan as the bigger retention bet.
- **Free-to-Play Game Economy & Balance** (Python, scikit-learn, SQL). Caught two premium items breaking the game (61% win rate, significant on a z-test) and slow coin inflation (sinks recover only ~63% of currency minted). Predicted likely future payers from their first three days (AUC 0.80) using D1/D7/D30 cohorts and turned it into an onboarding lever.
- **US Stock-Market Valuation & Risk** (Python, statsmodels, SQL). Across 150+ years, higher valuation (CAPE) predicts lower forward 10-year real returns ($p \sim 1e-40$); worst real drawdown -81%.
- **Playable browser games** (custom JavaScript engines, Supabase). Battle, a turn-based RPG with online PvP; RocketIO, a real-time hex-strategy game with 14 factions and an in-game missile economy. Built mobile-first and playable on phone and desktop. Portfolio: merogith.github.io/Portfolio
- **Idle games roadmap.** Building toward an idle tycoon and a single-player idle RPG. Idle systems are where I want to spend the next few years.

Experience

Independent Financial Coach - Self-employed (2024 - Present)

- Run a one-to-one practice turning budgeting, saving and investing into plain, actionable decisions; design each client's plan and run weekly check-ins in English and Turkish.

Omnichannel Data Analyst - Viatrix Inc. (Dec 2022 - Sep 2023)

- Consolidated records into one master record per person across 70+ markets (Salesforce); fuzzy matching cut manual validation by 40%; cleaned 1M+ records with SQL.

Business Intelligence Analyst - Saksı Kampüs (early-stage edtech) (Dec 2021 - Oct 2022)

- Tracked retention, engagement and CAC in Google Analytics and Looker Studio and steered Meta Ads spend; wrote the business plan and growth projections behind a seed crowdfunding raise.

Sales & Financial Analysis Intern - Garanti BBVA Investment (Jul 2021 - Sep 2021)

- Built DCF and comparable-company valuation models and set target prices for sell-side equity research.

Education

- M.Sc. Corporate Management - University of Europe for Applied Sciences, Berlin (2022 - 2024).
- B.Sc. Environmental Engineering - METU, Ankara (2013 - 2021).

Honors: published paper "Generative AI in Pharma" (ADCAIJ); Google AI Essentials; METU summer-practice award.

Languages

English (full professional); Turkish (native); Portuguese (dual citizen).